

The **simplex** package

Linguistic example environments for L^AT_EX

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Abstract

The **simplex** package provides three numbered example environments for use in linguistics papers—**unlabeledexample**, **shortexample**, and **example**—together with interlinear gloss macros (`\gll`, `\glll`, `\glt`, `\gln`, `\glend`) adapted from `covington.sty` and `gloss.tex`.

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1 Introduction

Linguistics papers routinely include numbered examples, sometimes with descriptive labels, and frequently with word-by-word interlinear glosses paired with a free translation. The **simplex** package provides a minimal, self-contained set of macros for both tasks.

The gloss alignment code is adapted from `gloss.tex` (v1.0, Marcel R. van der Goot, 1991) and `covington.sty` (Michael Covington). The example counter environments are original.

2 Requirements

simplex requires L^AT_EX 2_ε and automatically loads the xparse package (part of the standard L^AT_EX distribution).

3 Package options

resetchapter The **resetchapter** option resets the **exampleno** counter at the start of each `\chapter`, so that numbering restarts at (1) in every chapter. It requires a document class that defines `\chapter` (e.g. `report` or `book`).

```
\usepackage[resetchapter]{simplex}
```

Without this option (the default), **exampleno** simply increments throughout the document, as in v1.0. Enabling it also changes what `\exref` (§4) prints for cross-chapter references; see below.

4 Numbered example environments

All three environments share a single counter, **exampleno**, which increments automatically and is typeset as an Arabic numeral in parentheses, e.g. (1), (2), ...

unlabeledexample (*env.*) The **unlabeledexample** environment produces a numbered example with no label. It takes no arguments.

```
\begin{unlabeledexample}
The cat sat on the mat.
\end{unlabeledexample}
```

(1) The cat sat on the mat.

shortexample (*env.*) The **shortexample** environment produces a numbered example whose optional label appears on the *same line* as the number. The label is given as an optional argument in square brackets.

```
\begin{shortexample}[\textsc{Substance-freeness of structural change}]
Features changed by rule application need not be present in the rule's
structural environment.
\end{shortexample}
```

(2) SUBSTANCE-FREENESS OF STRUCTURAL CHANGE: Features changed by rule application need not be present in the rule's structural environment.

example (*env.*) The **example** environment is like **shortexample** except that the label appears on a *separate line* above the example content, separated by a small vertical skip. This is useful when the label is long or when the content is multi-line (such as a gloss block).

```
\begin{example}[Assibilating perfect passive participles and agents]
\begin{tabular}{H}{llllll}
metere & 'reap' & messus & 'harvested' & messor & 'reaper' \\
fodere & 'dig' & fossus & 'dug' & fossor & 'digger' \\
\end{tabular}
\end{example}
```

(3) Assibilating perfect passive participles and agents:

metere	‘reap’	messus	‘harvested’	messor	‘reaper’
fodere	‘dig’	fossus	‘dug’	fossor	‘digger’

4.1 Cross-referencing

All three environments call `\refstepcounter`, so standard `\label/\ref` cross-referencing works normally.

```
\begin{unlabeledexample}  
The cat sat on the mat.  
\label{ex:basic}  
\end{unlabeledexample}
```

See (`\ref{ex:basic}`).

\exref `\exref` is an alternative to `\ref` purpose-built for citing examples: it adds the surrounding parentheses itself, and—when the `resetchapter` option (§3) is in effect—it automatically includes the chapter number for references that cross a chapter boundary.

See `\exref{ex:basic}`.

With `resetchapter` *not* given, `\exref{ex:basic}` simply prints (1), matching (`\ref{ex:basic}`). With `resetchapter` given, a reference to an example in the *current* chapter still prints as (1), but a reference to an example in chapter 2 cited from a later chapter prints as (2/1).

`\exref` also takes an optional argument that postpones a letter inside the parentheses, for referring to a sub-part of an example:

See `\exref[a]{ex:basic}`.

which prints (1a), or (2/1a) for a cross-chapter reference under `resetchapter`.

`\exref` reads the label’s stored value directly rather than via `\ref`, so it is unaffected by packages (such as `hyperref`) that redefine `\ref`; it does not currently add a hyperlink of its own.

5 Interlinear gloss macros

`simplex` provides macros for typesetting word-aligned interlinear glosses of the kind common in linguistic fieldwork and typological work. The macros accept two or three lines of space-separated tokens and stack them vertically, aligning each column.

5.1 Two- and three-line glosses: `\gll` and `\glll`

\gll `\gll` introduces a two-line gloss: a source-language line followed by a morpheme-gloss line. The two lines are separated by a literal newline (end of line) inside the macro argument; each line ends with `\\`. After the two gloss lines, supply a translation with `\glt` (or `\gln` if no translation is needed), and optionally close with `\glend`.

`\glll` `\glll` is like `\gll` but accepts three aligned lines (typically: source, morpheme gloss, and a second-tier gloss or transliteration).

```
\begin{example}[\textsc{Pre-Liquid Shortening} bled by external sandhi]
\gll clāmōr=ad cael-um
      shout=to heaven-\textsc{acc.sg.}
\glt ‘a shout to heaven’ %(fragments of Ennius)
      Omitted---no-op here.
\glend
\end{example}
```

(4) PRE-LIQUID SHORTENING bled by external sandhi:

```
clāmōr=ad cael-um
shout=to heaven-ACC.SG.
‘a shout to heaven’
```

5.2 Translation and closing macros

`\glt` `\glt` closes the aligned gloss block and introduces a free translation. It must appear after the final gloss line even when no translation is needed (pass an empty line in that case).

`\gln` `\gln` is an alternative to `\glt` for use when no translation is wanted at all; it closes the gloss block without adding a newline.

`\glend` `\glend` is a semantic no-op provided for readability; it marks the end of a gloss block.

5.3 Customizing gloss fonts

Three token-list hooks control the font applied to each line:

<code>\eachwordone</code>	font for the source line (default: <code>\rm</code>)
<code>\eachwordtwo</code>	font for the first gloss line (default: <code>\rm</code>)
<code>\eachwordthree</code>	font for the second gloss line (default: <code>\rm</code>)

To italicize the source line, for example, add to your preamble:

```
\let\eachwordone=\it
```

The inter-word spacing in gloss blocks is controlled by the skip register `\glossglue`, whose default value is 5pt plus 2pt minus 1pt.

6 Known limitations

- Per-chapter numbering requires the `resetchapter` option (§3); it is off by default for backward compatibility with v1.0 documents.
- `\gll` and `\glll` rely on active end-of-line characters and may behave unexpectedly inside certain environments or macro arguments.
- Long words without spaces will not be broken across lines.

7 License

This package is copyright © Kyle Gorman and is distributed under the L^AT_EX Project Public License, version 1.3 or later (<http://www.latex-project.org/lppl.txt>). The gloss alignment code in `simplex.sty` was adapted from `gloss.tex` by Marcel R. van der Goot (1991). Additional adaptations are derived from `covington.sty` by Michael Covington.

8 Version history

v1.1 (2026/06/30) Added the `resetchapter` package option and the `\exref` cross-referencing macro (with optional postposed letter).

v1.0 (2026/03/02) Initial public release.